

Sustainable Forest Management

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Summary

Most respondents indicated that deforestation, charcoal production and fire frequency were decreasing, wildlife populations were increasing and natural resource management was improving within CFs. Most FDG groups also indicated that both deforestation and charcoal production were also decreasing outside their CF, suggesting there is no leakage effect. Community female FDGs tended to have a more positive view of the impact of CFM compared to the other groups, which is noteworthy given it is primarily the women who harvest forest products, but who often do not have voice in traditional natural resource management. However, it is also important to note that a small number of FDG groups and individual interviewees suggested the situation was worsening in their CFs. It will be important to identify CFs that are doing less well and address the problems. Not many CFMGs were practising natural forest restoration or establishing plantations. Existing CFs should be expanded and new one designed, so that they incorporate degraded areas that can become the focus of restoration and plantation activities. There is a considerable opportunity for CFM to contribute to national restoration and plantation targets, but currently this is not being realised.

Introduction

In this chapter, we consider the effect of community forestry on indicators of SFM. The information analysed is based entirely only on the responses of interviewees to our survey tool. In the next chapter we will consider the effects of CF on SMF as measured through remote sensing derived metrics.

Deforestation

We asked interviewees whether CFM has reduced deforestation inside their CF and whether or not deforestation has increased outside their CF.

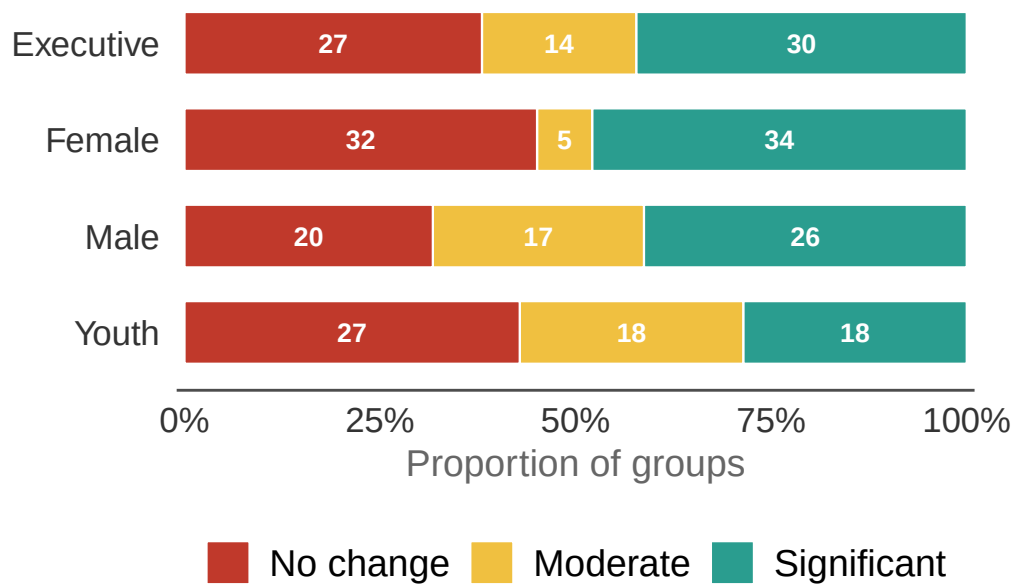


Figure 1: ‘Has CFM reduced deforestation inside the community forest?’ The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of FGD groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Deforestation inside the community forest

A majority of groups reported either a moderate or significant reduction in deforestation inside the CF (Figure 1). Moreover, these answers were consistent across the FGD groups. There were no significant differences in response among FGD types (Table 1). However, the quality of governance, as measured by the governance index we generated in the previous chapter, was a highly significant predictor of the perceived decrease in deforestation within the CF (Table 1).

Table 1: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived reduction in deforestation inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in deforestation inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM model with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 254.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	−0.133	0.354	0.7081
Male	0.137	0.351	0.6971
Youth	−0.412	0.347	0.2355
Governance index	0.291	0.071	0.0000

Among the individual interviewees (Table 2), a majority of interviewees also indicated that CFM had reduced deforestation inside the CF and the differences among the interviewee roles were not significant (Table 3).

Table 2: Perceived reduction in deforestation inside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived reduction in deforestation inside the community forest by interviewee role

Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	No change	Moderate	Significant
CFMG executive member	60	17%	23%	60%
Community member	29	28%	24%	48%
Traditional leader	70	50%	17%	33%
District Forestry Officer	51	22%	51%	27%
NGO representative	30	20%	40%	40%

Table 3: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived reduction in deforestation inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in deforestation inside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

We used a CLMM model with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 240.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
CFMG executive member	0.075	0.512	0.8841
Traditional leader	−0.943	0.490	0.0542
DFO	−0.701	0.493	0.1552
NGO representative	−0.225	0.545	0.6803
Gender: male	0.776	0.362	0.0320
Age	−0.016	0.012	0.1878

Deforestation outside the community forest

Sometimes when activities are proscribed in a particular area they may be displaced other areas; an effect known as leakage. Hence, to investigate possible leakage effects, we also asked interviewees whether CFM had led to an increase in deforestation outside their community forest (Figure 2).

Contrary to the expectations of leakage, a majority of the FGD groups responded that CFM had actually reduced deforestation outside their CF. Moreover, as with the results for inside the CF, the responses were consistent across FGD groups (Table 4).

Table 4: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM model with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 209.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	0.975	0.441	0.0270
Male	−0.083	0.461	0.8577
Youth	0.052	0.426	0.9022
Governance index	0.073	0.088	0.4095

Among the individual interviewees (Table 5), the individuals from the communities agreed that deforestation outside their CF had decreased. However, NGO representatives and DFOs were

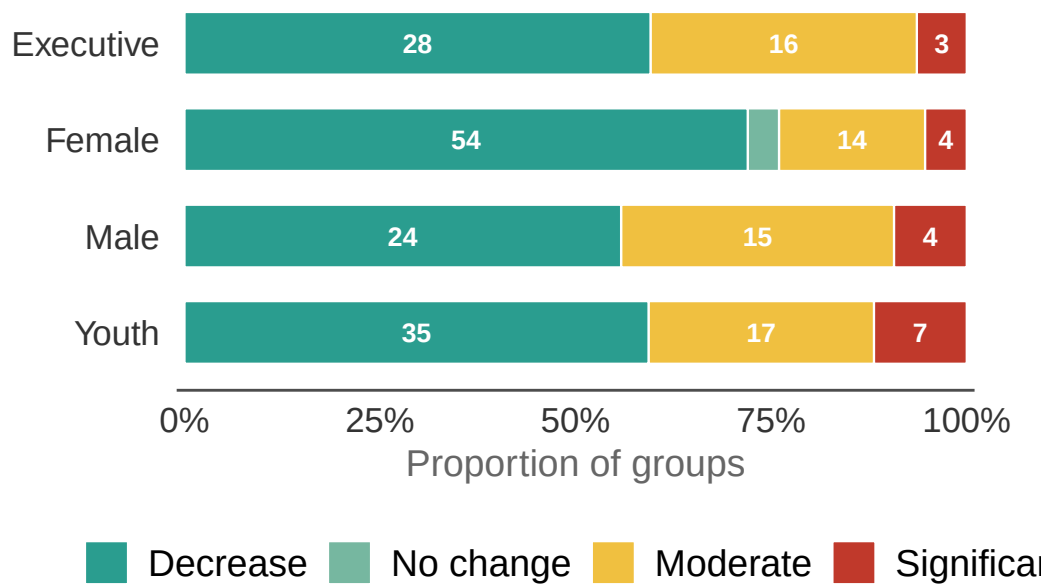


Figure 2: 'Has CFM increased deforestation outside the community forest?' The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

less likely to suggest deforestation had decreased outside the CF and more likely to suggest a moderate increase in deforestation.

Table 5: Perceived increase in deforestation outside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived increase in deforestation outside the community forest by interviewee role
Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Decrease	Moderate	Significant	No change
CFMG executive member	56	75%	16%	9%	0%
Community member	28	50%	39%	11%	0%
Traditional leader	68	72%	21%	6%	1%
District Forestry Officer	40	25%	52%	20%	2%
NGO representative	23	39%	48%	13%	0%

The effects of the gender and age of the interviewee were not a significant determinant of their response. However, the differences in opinion between the CFMG executive members and NGO representatives and DFOs, and between traditional leaders and NGO representatives and DFOs, were significant (Table 6, Table 7).

Table 6: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

We used a CLMM model with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 215.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	1.196	0.518	0.0211
Traditional leader	1.132	0.502	0.0241
DFO	-0.833	0.508	0.1010
NGO representative	-0.396	0.582	0.4968
Gender: male	-0.271	0.398	0.4954
Age	-0.014	0.013	0.2738

Table 7: Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in deforestation outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role
Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Community member - CFMG exec member	−1.196	0.518	−2.306	0.1427
Community member - Trad leader	−1.132	0.502	−2.255	0.1598
Community member - dfo	0.833	0.508	1.640	0.4718
Community member - NGO rep	0.396	0.582	0.680	0.9609
CFMG exec member - Trad leader	0.064	0.476	0.134	0.9999
CFMG exec member - dfo	2.028	0.467	4.347	0.0001
CFMG exec member - NGO rep	1.591	0.572	2.783	0.0429
Trad leader - dfo	1.964	0.482	4.077	0.0004
Trad leader - NGO rep	1.527	0.569	2.685	0.0562
dfo - NGO rep	−0.437	0.523	−0.836	0.9194

Charcoal production

We asked interviewees whether CFM had reduced charcoal production inside their CF and whether it had increased immediately outside their CF.

Charcoal production inside the community forest

Almost all the FGD groups agreed that charcoal making inside their CF had decreased, with most indicating that charcoal making had decreased significantly (Figure 3). The small differences in responses among FGD groups were not significant (Table 8).

Table 8: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM model with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 272.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	1.525	0.826	0.0647
Male	0.100	0.569	0.8598
Youth	0.478	0.615	0.4366
Governance index	−0.056	0.135	0.6811

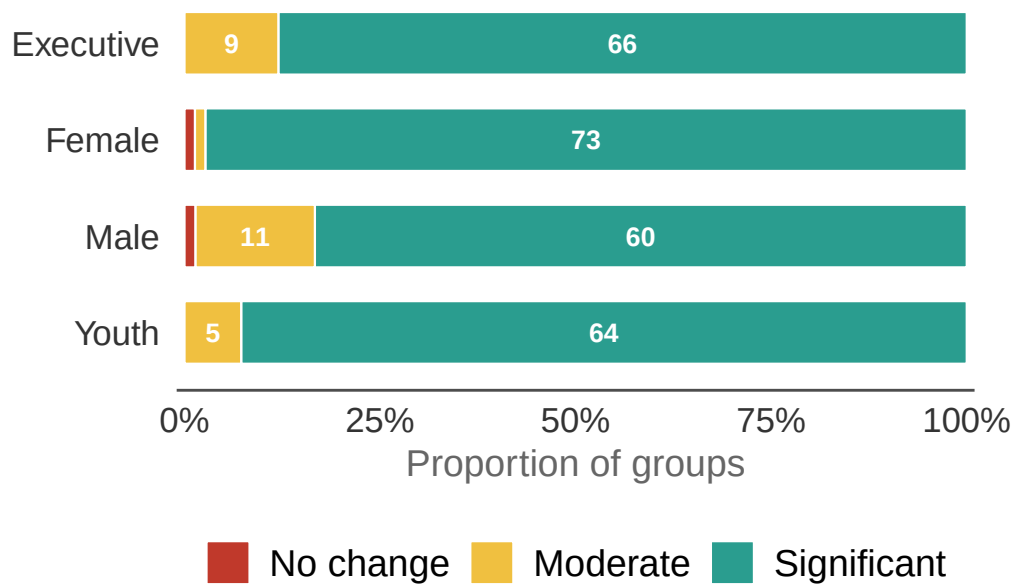


Figure 3: ‘Has CFM reduced charcoal production inside the community forest?’ The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Likewise, among the individual interviewees (Table 9), almost all interviewees agreed that there had been a substantial decrease in charcoal making inside their CF. Again, this result was consistent across interviewee roles (there were no significant differences among roles) (Table 10).

Table 9: Perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the community forest by interviewee role

Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Moderate	Significant	No change
CFMG executive member	63	14%	86%	0%
Community member	31	26%	74%	0%
Traditional leader	74	11%	86%	3%
District Forestry Officer	50	20%	80%	0%
NGO representative	30	17%	80%	3%

Table 10: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in charcoal production inside the CF <U+2014>interviewee role, gender and age

We used a CLMM model random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 248.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	0.829	0.635	0.1919
Traditional leader	0.422	0.636	0.5074
DFO	0.006	0.642	0.9922
NGO representative	0.256	0.712	0.7195
Gender: male	-0.892	0.604	0.1399
Age	-0.001	0.016	0.9361

Charcoal production outside the community forest

To examine for the possibility of leakage, we also asked interviewees whether CFM has led to an increase in charcoal production outside their CF (Figure 4).

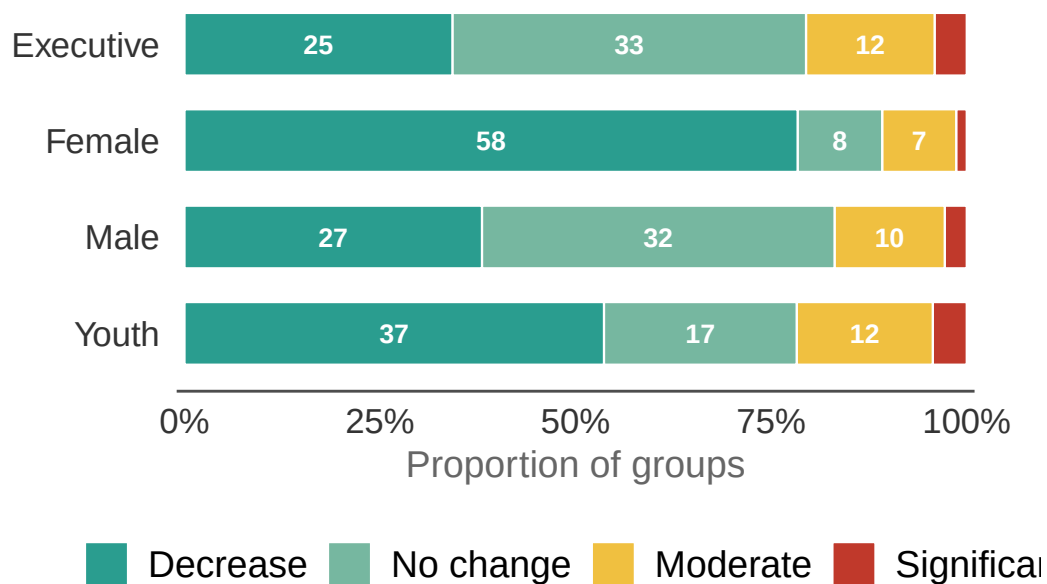


Figure 4: ‘Has CFM increased charcoal production outside the community forest?’ The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

As can be seen, the vast majority of groups indicated that charcoal making had also decreased outside their CF. However, there were a small number that indicated charcoal making had increased, with some indicating it had increased significantly. Female FGD groups were significantly more likely to indicate that charcoal making had decreased outside the CF than all other groups (CFMG executive members, male or youth community members) (Table 11). There were no significant differences among these other groups (Table 12), who most often indicated that there was no change in the amount of charcoal making outside the CF.

Table 11: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 269.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	−1.966	0.400	0.0000
Male	−0.055	0.320	0.8627
Youth	−0.566	0.337	0.0931
Governance index	−0.016	0.069	0.8194

Table 12: Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> FGD type.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> FGD type

Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	1.966	0.400	4.919	0.0000
Executive - Male	0.055	0.320	0.173	0.9982
Executive - Youth	0.566	0.337	1.679	0.3346
Female - Male	−1.910	0.409	−4.670	0.0000
Female - Youth	−1.400	0.413	−3.387	0.0039
Male - Youth	0.511	0.346	1.476	0.4521

Among the individual interviewees (Table 13), similar to the results on deforestation, most community interviewees suggested there had been a decrease or no change in charcoal production outside the CF. However, NGO representatives and DFOs were significantly more likely to indicate that there had been an increase in charcoal production outside the CF (Table 14, Table 15).

Table 13: Perceived increase in charcoal production outside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived increase in charcoal production outside the community forest by interviewee role

Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Decrease	No change	Moderate	Significant
CFMG executive member	63	73%	8%	13%	6%
Community member	30	73%	7%	20%	0%
Traditional leader	73	70%	14%	10%	7%
District Forestry Officer	45	40%	20%	27%	13%
NGO representative	30	50%	17%	30%	3%

Table 14: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

We used a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 241.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	0.142	0.598	0.8121
Traditional leader	-0.088	0.573	0.8775
DFO	1.847	0.616	0.0027
NGO representative	1.563	0.651	0.0164
Gender: male	0.093	0.386	0.8101
Age	0.043	0.014	0.0015

Table 15: Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived increase in charcoal production outside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role

Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	P value
Community member - CFMG exec member	-0.142	0.598	-0.238	0.9993

Community member - Trad leader	0.088	0.573	0.154	0.9999
Community member - dfo	−1.847	0.616	−3.001	0.0226
Community member - NGO rep	−1.563	0.651	−2.401	0.1150
CFMG exec member - Trad leader	0.230	0.473	0.487	0.9886
CFMG exec member - dfo	−1.705	0.476	−3.582	0.0031
CFMG exec member - NGO rep	−1.420	0.530	−2.681	0.0567
Trad leader - dfo	−1.936	0.497	−3.895	0.0009
Trad leader - NGO rep	−1.651	0.551	−2.997	0.0228
dfo - NGO rep	0.285	0.477	0.597	0.9756

Fire

We asked interviewees about fire monitoring practices and whether CFM had reduced fire incidence inside their CF. We did not ask about changes in fire frequency outside the CF, because clearing fields for agriculture or improving grazing often involves burning.

Fire monitoring

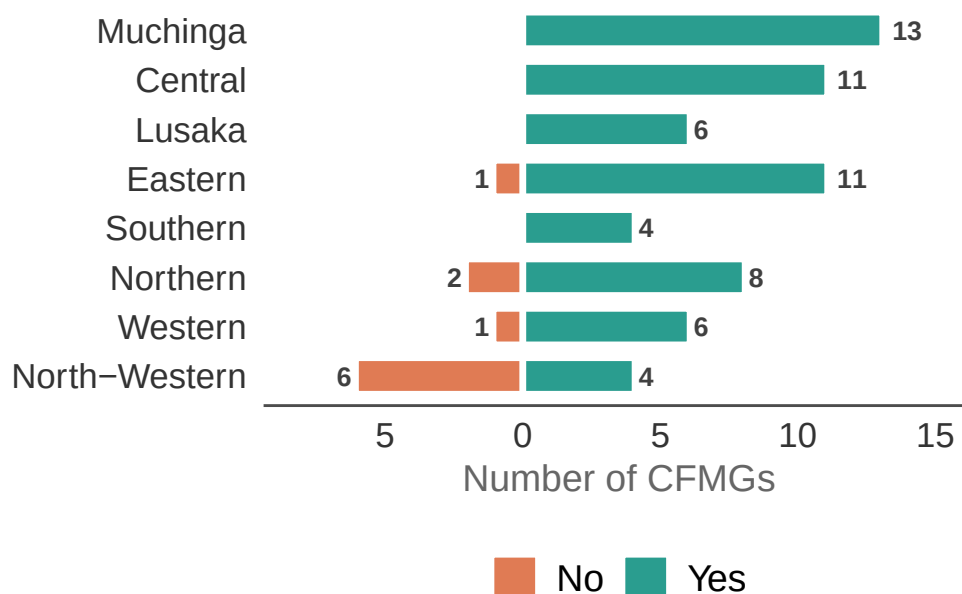


Figure 5: Whether CFMGs have established fire monitoring in the community forest by province. The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either monitoring fires (Yes) or not (No). The numbers on the bars represent the actual number of CFMGs in each category.

As can be seen in the figure (Figure 5), most CFMGs have instigated a system of fire monitoring. However, ten CFMGs across four provinces from our sample of 75 did not have any system of fire monitoring.

Fire incidence inside the community forest

We asked interviewees whether CFM has reduced fire incidence inside their CF (Figure 6).

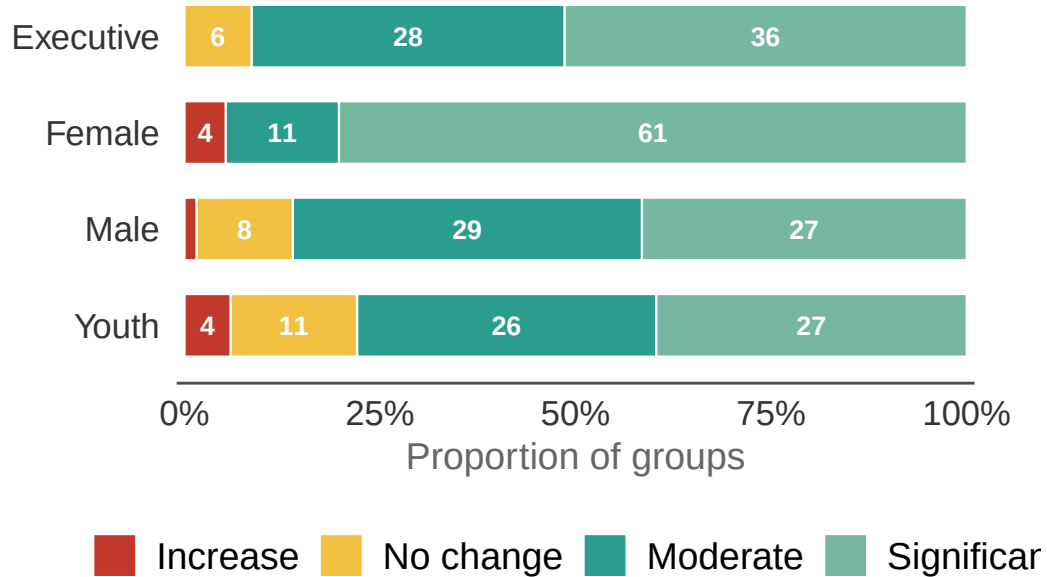


Figure 6: ‘Has CFM reduced fire incidence inside the community forest?’ The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

As can be seen, a majority of groups reported a moderate or significant reduction in fire incidence in the CF. Female FDGs reported more significant declines in fire frequency compared to the other groups, who reported more moderate declines (Table 16). These differences between female FDG groups and the other FDG groups (CFMG Executives, male and youth) were significant (Table 17).

Table 16: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We use a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 261.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	1.632	0.432	0.0002
Male	−0.460	0.360	0.2010
Youth	−0.717	0.351	0.0410
Governance index	0.167	0.082	0.0422

Table 17: Pairwise comparisons for perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type

Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	−1.632	0.432	−3.778	0.0009
Executive - Male	0.460	0.360	1.279	0.5765
Executive - Youth	0.717	0.351	2.044	0.1721
Female - Male	2.092	0.451	4.640	0.0000
Female - Youth	2.349	0.443	5.302	0.0000
Male - Youth	0.257	0.361	0.711	0.8928

Among the individual interviewees (Table 18), there were also some differences in opinion. Community members tended to say there had been a significant reduction in fire frequency inside their CF, whereas NGO representatives and DFOs more often suggested a moderate reduction or no change. However, these differences were not significant (Table 19).

Table 18: Perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the community forest by interviewee role
Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Significant	Moderate	No change	Increase
CFMG executive member	63	73%	27%	0%	0%

Community member	30	67%	27%	3%	3%
Traditional leader	75	63%	24%	4%	9%
District Forestry Officer	54	44%	39%	17%	0%
NGO representative	31	45%	45%	3%	6%

Table 19: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF.

Model results for perceived reduction in fire incidence inside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

CLMM; random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 253.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	0.341	0.514	0.5073
Traditional leader	−0.266	0.514	0.6047
DFO	−0.613	0.520	0.2382
NGO representative	−0.669	0.562	0.2340
Gender: male	−0.609	0.381	0.1104
Age	0.010	0.012	0.4079

Wildlife

We asked interviewees whether CFM had led to an increase in wildlife inside their CF (Figure 7).

As can be seen, a majority of groups indicated a significant or moderate increase in wildlife in their CF. However, there were some that indicated there had been a decrease. The responses among FGD types were not significantly different (Table 20).

Table 20: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived increase in wildlife inside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in wildlife inside the CF <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive. n = 244.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
Female	−0.141	0.391	0.7189
Male	−0.174	0.377	0.6442

Youth	−0.382	0.358	0.2862
Governance index	−0.031	0.108	0.7724

Among the individual interviewees (Table 21), there were also some differences in opinion. For example, only 3% of NGO representatives suggested there had been a decline in wildlife in the CF, compared to between 10% and 22% for the other interviewee roles. However, again these differences were not significant (Table 22).

Table 21: Perceived increase in wildlife inside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived increase in wildlife by interviewee role

Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Decrease	No change	Moderate	Significant
CFMG executive member	61	10%	3%	43%	44%
Community member	27	22%	15%	30%	33%
Traditional leader	73	19%	11%	34%	36%
District Forestry Officer	37	14%	24%	43%	19%
NGO representative	31	3%	10%	48%	39%

Table 22: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived increase in wildlife inside the CF.

Model results for perceived increase in wildlife inside the CF <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

We used a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 229.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	0.438	0.536	0.4135
Traditional leader	0.105	0.523	0.8408
DFO	−0.499	0.563	0.3753
NGO representative	0.741	0.586	0.2062
Gender: male	−0.663	0.391	0.0899
Age	0.007	0.013	0.6022

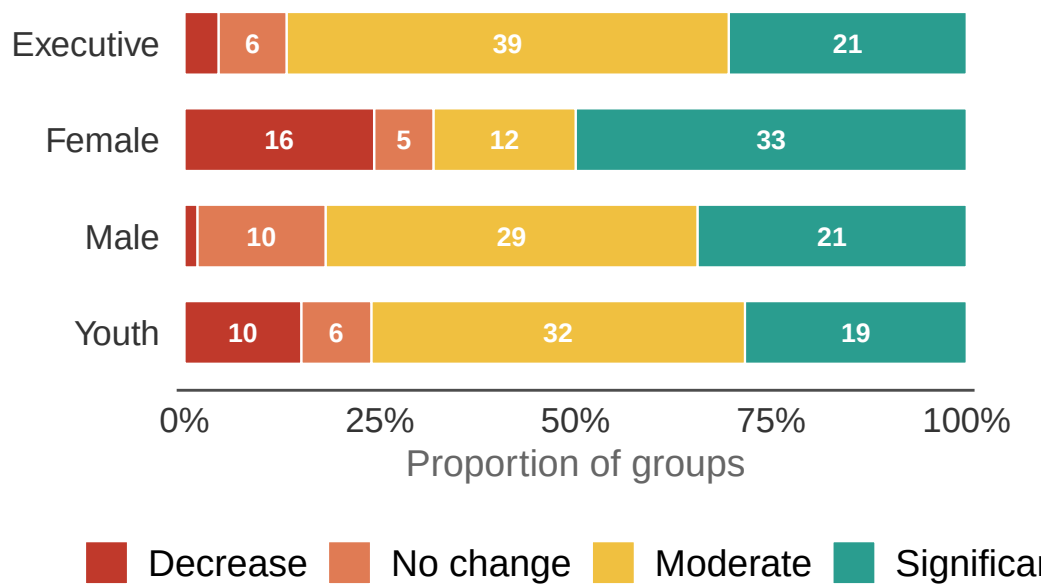


Figure 7: 'Has CFM led to an increase in wildlife in the community forest?' The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Forest resources management

We asked interviewees whether CFM had improved the management of forest resources inside their CF (Figure 8).

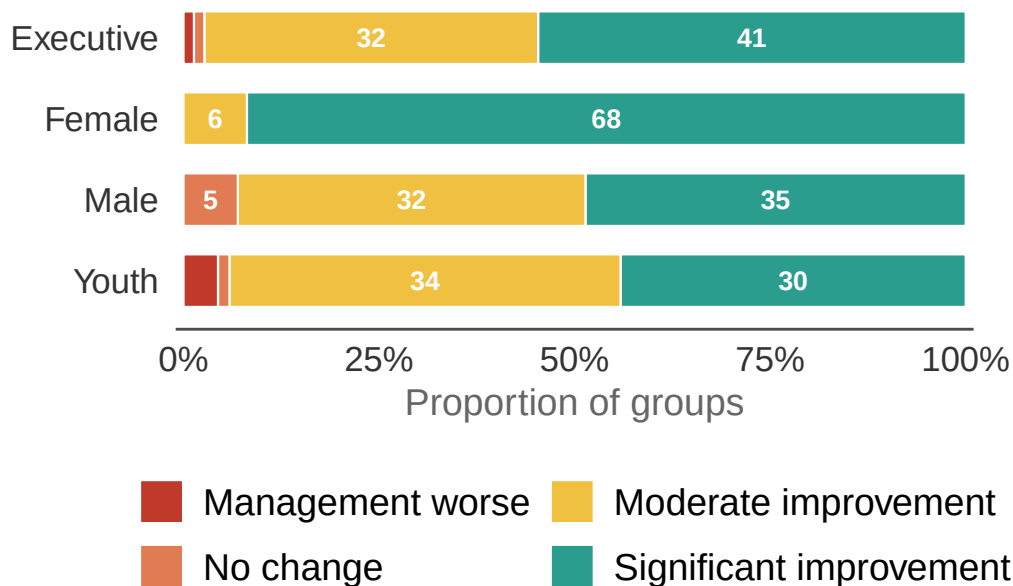


Figure 8: ‘Has CFM improved forest resources management inside the community forest?’ The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

As can be seen, while responses vary among FGD groups, most groups agreed that the management of forest resources had improved moderately or significantly under CFM, and only a small number of primarily youth groups considered that it had gotten worse. A very high proportion of community female FDG groups considered that the management of forest resources was significantly better under CFM, a difference that was statistically significant (Table 23, Table 24).

Table 23: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on perceived improvement in forest resources management.

Model results for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> FGD type and governance index

We used a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference = Executive.
n = 270.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Female	3.379	0.678	0.0000
Male	−0.156	0.389	0.6873
Youth	−0.650	0.387	0.0932
Governance index	0.253	0.110	0.0217

Table 24: Pairwise comparisons for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> FGD type.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> FGD type

Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	−3.379	0.678	−4.987	0.0000
Executive - Male	0.156	0.389	0.403	0.9779
Executive - Youth	0.650	0.387	1.679	0.3348
Female - Male	3.535	0.687	5.144	0.0000
Female - Youth	4.029	0.704	5.722	0.0000
Male - Youth	0.494	0.400	1.233	0.6055

We also asked which specific forest resources had improved under CFM (Figure 9).

Among the individual interviewees (Table 25), the vast majority of interviewees considered that the management of forest resources had improved under CFM. There was a significant difference in responses between community members and DFOs. The DFOs were more likely to suggest there had been no change or only a moderate improvement in forest resource management under CFM, compared to the much higher proportion of interviewees indicating a significant improvement among community representatives (Table 26, Table 27).

Table 25: Perceived change in forest resources management inside the community forest by individual interviewee role.

Perceived improvement in forest resources management by interviewee role
Values represent the % of respondents in each response category. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Management worse	No change	Moderate improvement	Significant improvement
CFMG executive member	63	0%	0%	29%	71%
Community member	31	3%	0%	32%	65%
Traditional leader	75	7%	5%	31%	57%
District Forestry Officer	55	4%	11%	55%	31%
NGO representative	31	0%	0%	42%	58%

Table 26: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on perceived improvement in forest resources management.

Model results for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> interviewee role, gender and age

We use a CLMM with random intercepts for province and CF within province. Reference role = Community member; reference gender = female. n = 255.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
CFMG executive member	0.075	0.595	0.8998
Traditional leader	-0.491	0.561	0.3813
DFO	-1.902	0.593	0.0013
NGO representative	-0.695	0.653	0.2869
Gender: male	-2.333	0.538	0.0000
Age	-0.009	0.014	0.5118

Table 27: Pairwise comparisons for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> interviewee role.

Pairwise comparisons for perceived improvement in forest resources management <U+2014> interviewee role

Tukey HSD adjustment.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	P value
Community member - CFMG exec member	-0.075	0.595	-0.126	0.9999
Community member - Trad leader	0.491	0.561	0.875	0.9060
Community member - dfo	1.902	0.593	3.207	0.0117
Community member - NGO rep	0.695	0.653	1.065	0.8246
CFMG exec member - Trad leader	0.566	0.473	1.197	0.7534

CFMG exec member - dfo	1.977	0.484	4.088	0.0004
CFMG exec member - NGO rep	0.770	0.564	1.365	0.6503
Trad leader - dfo	1.411	0.476	2.967	0.0250
Trad leader - NGO rep	0.204	0.563	0.363	0.9963
dfo - NGO rep	-1.207	0.515	-2.344	0.1311

Restoration

We asked CFMG executives whether natural forest restoration is practised inside the community forest (Figure 10). We restrict the responses for this question to CFMG executives, because this is the group that should be best informed about the activities of the CFMG (and the differences in responses among groups to this question are no of substantive interest).

Natural forest restoration is being practiced across approximately half of the CFs in our sample, mostly in Muchinga, Central and Northern provinces. We also asked CFMG executives about the specific restoration methods applied inside their CF (Figure 11). The majority were protecting natural regeneration. Only one CFMG was involved in planting native species and removal of invasives was not practised.

Plantations

In addition, we asked CFMG executives whether any plantations has been established inside the CF (Figure 12).

We also asked executives to estimate the number of hectares planted in the plantation. A small number (~9% of the sample) had established tree plantation inside their CF. However, the hectares planted were few (Figure 13).

Agroforestry

Last, we asked CFMG executives whether CFM has involved introducing agroforestry practices (Figure 14). In this context, agroforestry is implemented on agricultural land as a means for achieving sustainable intensification and reducing pressure on forests. Around 40% of CFMGs said that agroforestry had been introduced under CFM.

We also asked CFMG executives about the types of agroforestry practices present in the community (Figure 15).

We also asked CFMG executives about the species planted in agroforestry systems. Among the 30 CFMGs practising agroforestry most were employing intercropping with leguminous shrubs for soil heal management, but planting boundary trees or woodlots and homegardens were also popular interventions.



Figure 9: Forest resources that have improved under CFM, as reported by female, male, and youth FGDs. Word size is proportional to the number of FGDs reporting an improvement for each resource.

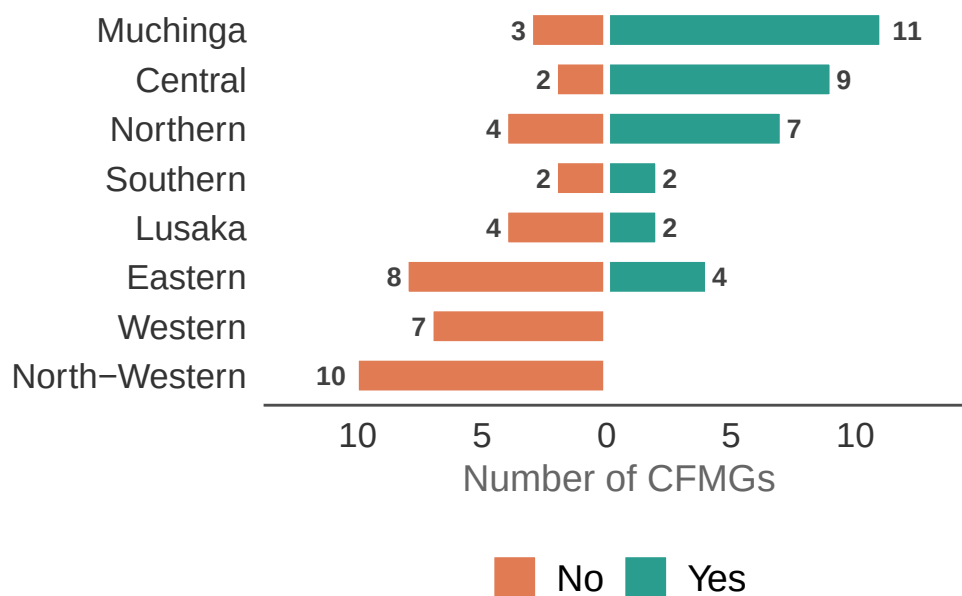


Figure 10: Whether CFMGs undertake natural forest restoration in the community forest by province. The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either undertaking restoration (Yes) or not (No). The numbers on the bars represent the actual number of CFMGs in each category.

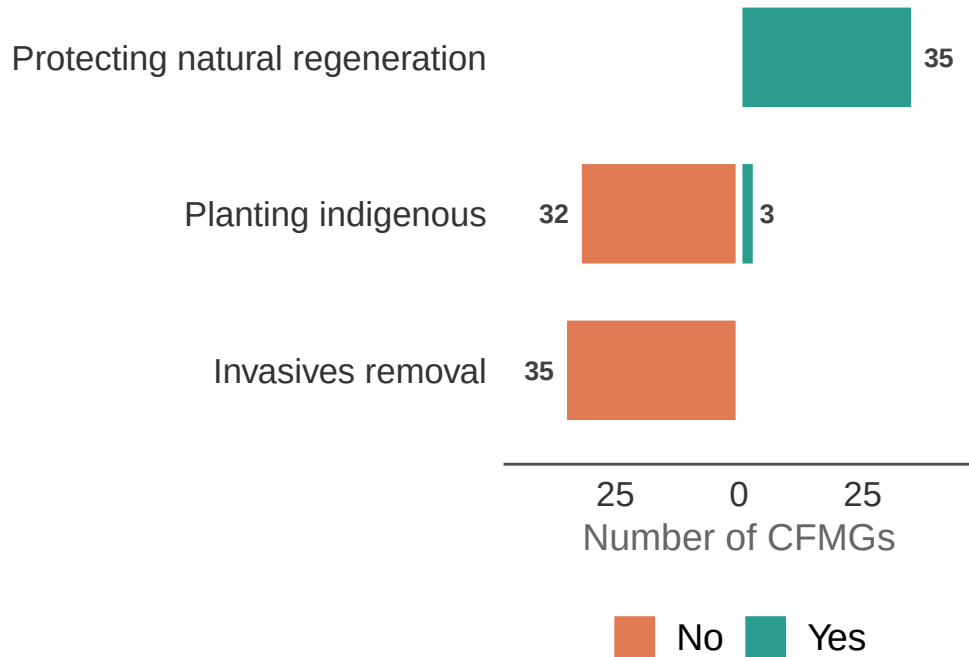


Figure 11: Restoration methods applied inside the community forest, as reported by CFMG executives. The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either using (Yes) or not using (No) each method. The numbers on the bars represent the actual number of CFMGs in each category.

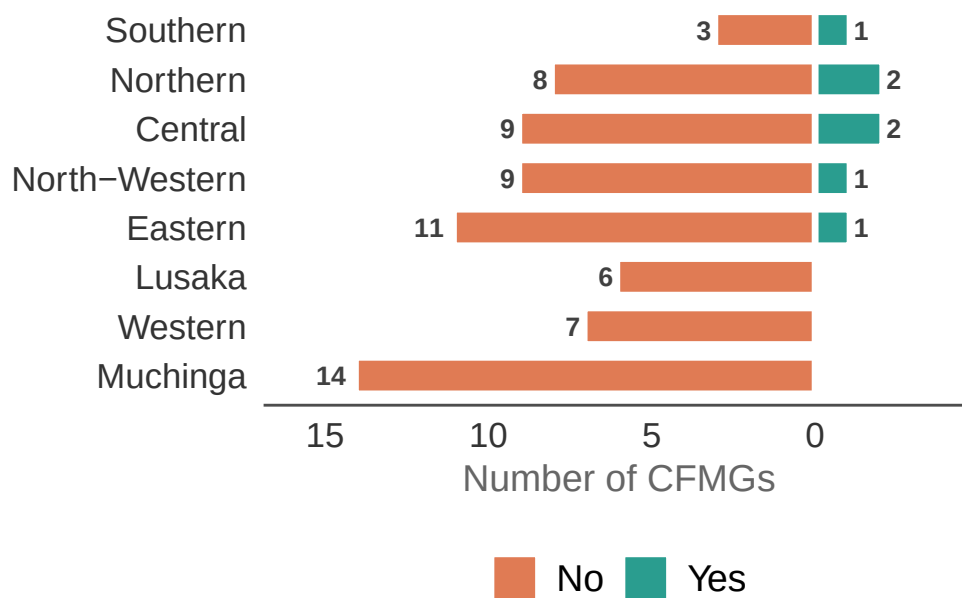


Figure 12: Whether CFMGs have established a plantation inside the community forest, by province. The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either with (Yes) or without (No) a plantation. The numbers on the bars represent the actual number of CFMGs in each category.

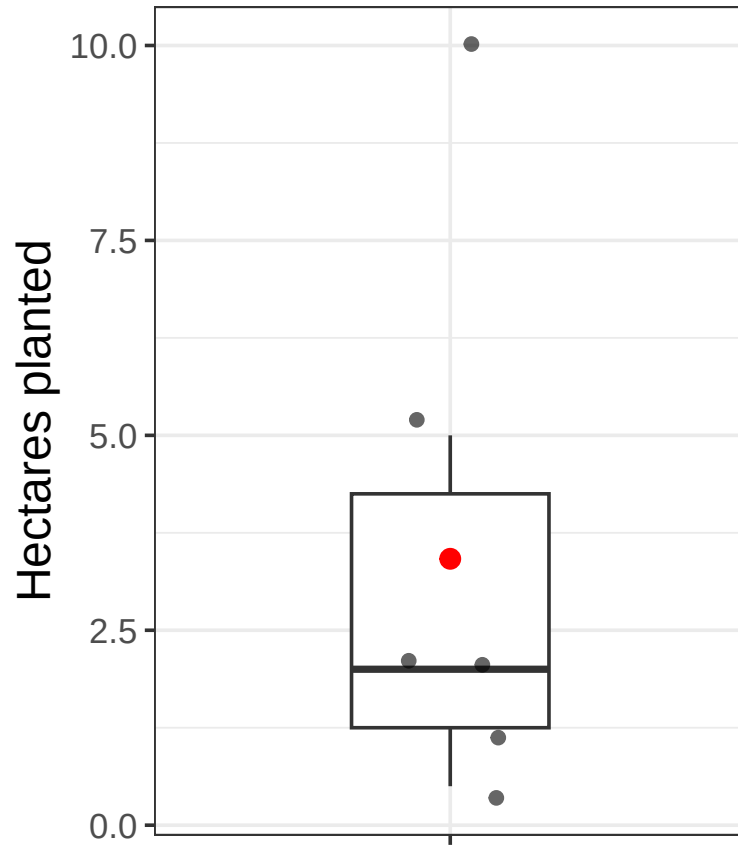


Figure 13: Estimated area of plantation established inside the community forest, as reported by CFMG executives ($n = 6$ CFMGs; total area = 20.5 ha). The horizontal bar is the median and the red dot is the mean. Species planted include *Gliricidia sepium* ($n = 3$ CFMGs), *Pinus* spp. ($n = 2$), *Acacia* spp. ($n = 1$), *Faidherbia albidia* ($n = 1$), and miombo species ($n = 1$).

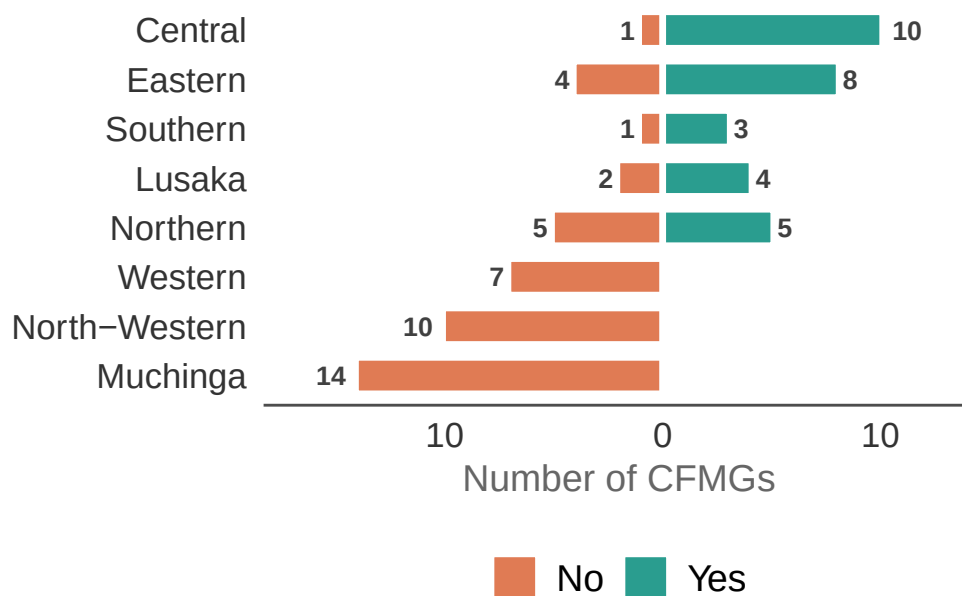


Figure 14: Whether agroforestry is employed to enhance SFM, as reported by CFMG executives. The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs reporting either a positive impact (Yes) or no impact (No). The numbers on the bars represent the actual number of CFMGs in each category.

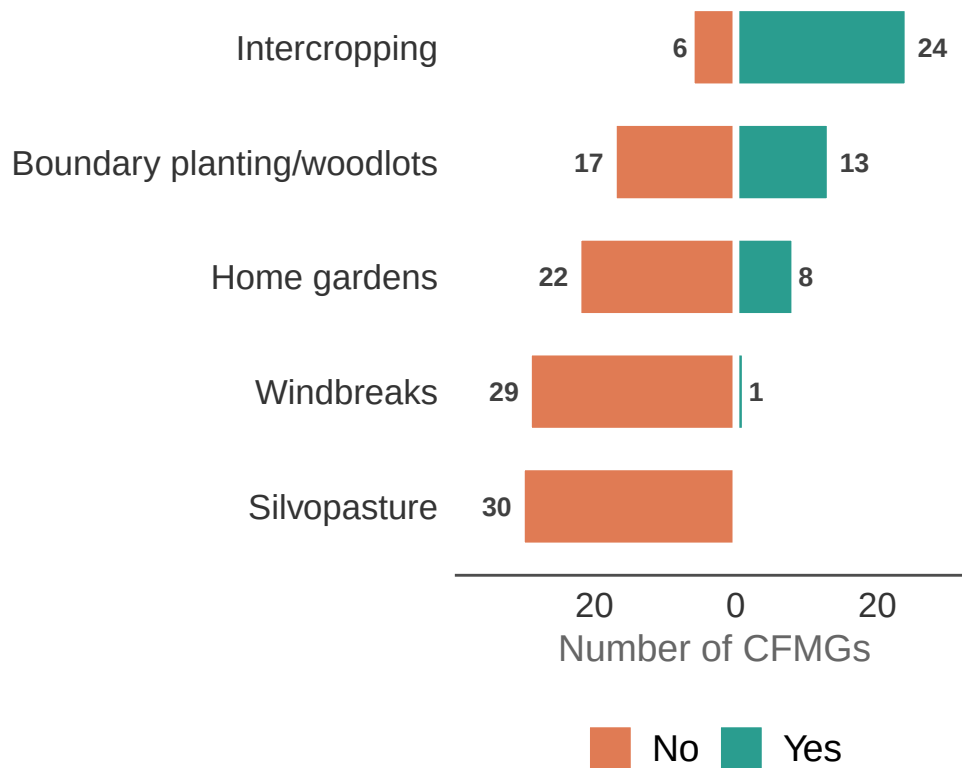


Figure 15: Types of agroforestry practices reported by CFMG executives (n = 30 CFMGs). The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either reporting (Yes) or not reporting (No) each practice.

Among the species used (Figure 16), we can see that *Gliricidia* and *Faidherbia*, leguminous shrubs and trees, respectively, were the most popular.

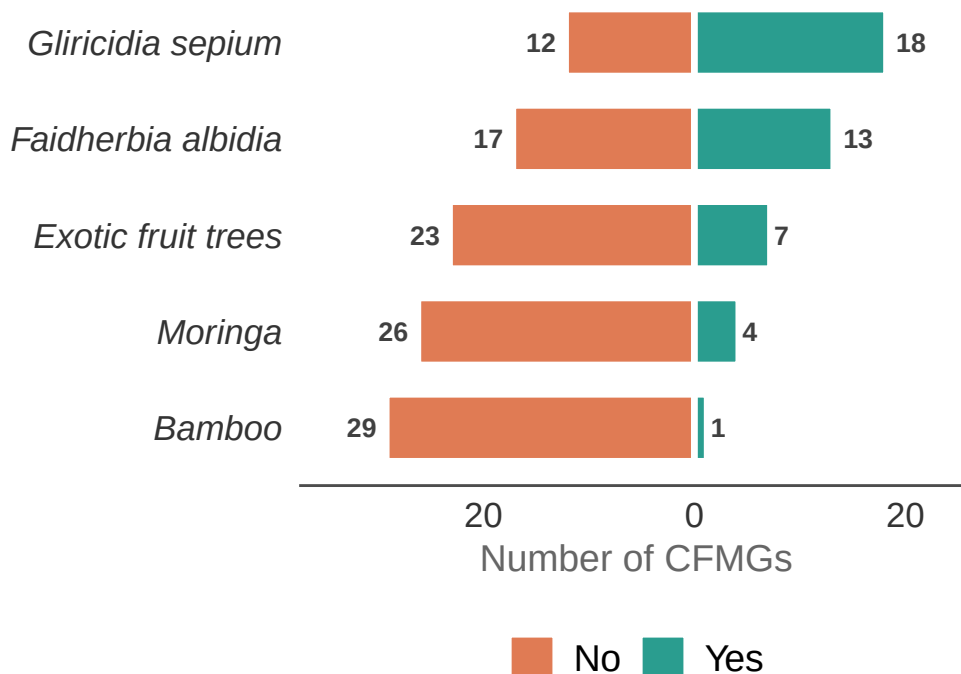


Figure 16: Agroforestry species planted, as reported by CFMG executives (n = 30 CFMGs). The length of the bars represents the number of CFMGs either planting (Yes) or not planting (No) each species.

SFM index

To summarise the overall SFM performance of each CFMG, we constructed an SFM index (0–5) by scoring five indicators of changes inside the CF — decrease in deforestation, decrease in charcoal production, decrease in fire incidence, increase in wildlife, and improved natural resources management — as 1 (positive change reported) or 0 (no change or worsening). Each indicator score was averaged across the Male, Female, and Youth community FGD groups, providing a community-level composite for each CFMG. We then tested whether the governance index was a significant predictor of overall SFM performance (Table 28, Figure 17).

Table 28: Linear mixed model of the CFMG SFM index.

Governance index as a predictor of SFM performance

Province random intercept variance = 0.073; residual variance = 0.415. Marginal $R^2 = 0.059$; conditional $R^2 = 0.199$. $n = 70$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept	3.655	0.213	0.0000
Governance index	0.082	0.039	0.0379

Discussion

All the indicators of SFM point to a situation that is improving under CFM, including deforestation, charcoal production, fire frequency, wildlife abundance and natural resource management. Interestingly, there does not appear to be any indication of leakage for most CFs. Most FDG groups indicated that both deforestation and charcoal production were also decreasing outside their CF. There were some differences in responses among the different FDG groups, with community female FDGs tending to have a more positive view of the impact of CFM compared to the other groups. This is interesting and may indicate that under CFM females have more of a voice in forest and forest resource management. Traditionally, women are highly dependent on forest resources, but usually have little say in forest management decisions. It would be worth following up this study to investigate what is driving this positive take on CFM among community women.

Among the individual interviewees, NGO representatives and DFOs tended to have a somewhat more conservative view with respect to positive changes, as compared to individuals from the communities. This may reflect that these professionals have a broader perspective from which to understand changes in forest and forest resource management. However, it could also arise from the fact that they are not as intimately involved in the forest management and hence less aware of the changes. Ultimately, monitoring over a longer period will enable better understanding of how CFM is changing forest management.

Overall, CFM appears to be engendering a change towards improved SFM. However, it is important to note that a small number of FDG groups and individual interviewees suggested the situation was worsening in their CFs. For the success of CFM in Zambia, it will be important to identify CFs that are doing less well, diagnose the causes and implement changes.

Some CFMGs were practicing forest restoration, mostly through protecting natural regeneration, and a few were establishing plantations. However, these activities were not widespread among CFMGs. Restoration - especially through protection of natural regeneration - should be integral to CFM and could be implemented across all CFs in Zambia. As this is an important indicator of SFM and there are government targets to restore 2,000,000 ha by 2030, the FD should integrate restoration targets into forest management plans for CFMGs and monitor outcomes. A problem is that the boundaries of many existing CFs were drawn around areas

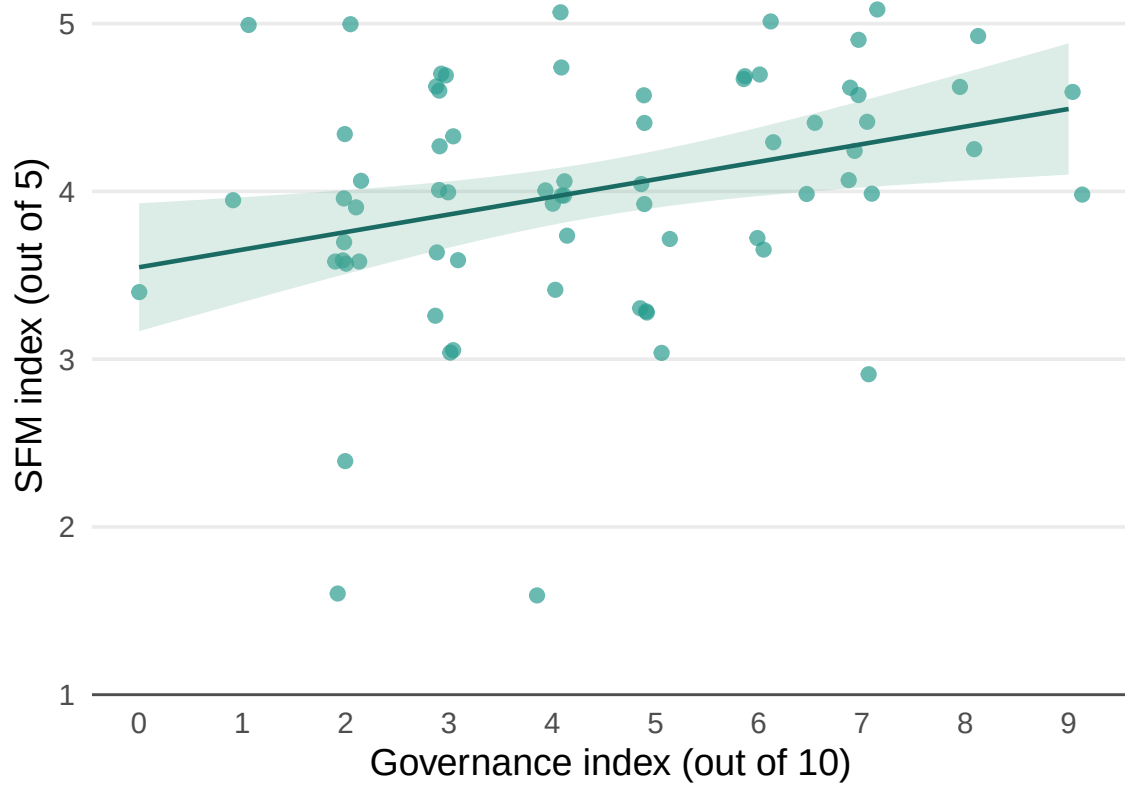


Figure 17: Relationship between the CFMG governance index and SFM index. Each point represents one CFMG. The line shows the fitted relationship from the linear mixed model, with the shaded band representing ± 1 SE.

containing on relatively good forest. The FD and communities should consider expand CF boundaries to incorporate areas for restoration activities, and for new CFs such areas should be incorporated from the outset. Agroforestry was also not widely practised by CFMGs, but is recognised tool for restoration of degraded agricultural land and can reduce pressure on forests. Plantations are also an important opportunity for CFM. Plantations can supply local building and fuelwood needs, thereby reducing pressure on natural forests. Through sustainable charcoal programmes, they can also supply energy for urban dwellers and again reduce pressure on natural forests. Last, Zambia has an acute shortage of high quality timber for uses such as telegraph poles and construction and imports large amounts of wood. A focus on developing plantations through CFM would go some way to meeting these needs, as well as generating a valuable additional source of income for rural communities.

In conclusion, our data suggest that CFM in Zambia is driving substantial improvements in SFM, reducing deforestation, charcoal production, and fire frequency, increasing wildlife populations, and improving natural resource management. However, it is important to note that these changes were not ubiquitous across all CFs. While some CFMGs are practising restoration and establishing plantations, there is a substantial opportunity to expand the role of CFM in meeting national restoration and plantation targets.